Soonhong Cho

Contact Information

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Education

2027	Ph.D., Political Science, **UCLA**
	Committee: Jeffrey Lewis, Chad Hazlett (co-chairs), Chris Tausanovitch, Ian Lundberg (Sociology)
2025	M.S., Statistics and Data Science, **UCLA**
2018	M.A., Political Science, **Seoul National University**
2016	B.A., Economics, Political Science (Minor: Philosophy), **Seoul National University**

Research Interests

Causal Inference, Political Methodology, American Politics, Public Opinion

Peer-Reviewed Publications

1. **Soonhong Cho**, Doeun Kim, and Chad Hazlett. 2026. Inference at the Data's Edge: Gaussian Processes for Estimation and Inference in the Face of Extrapolation Uncertainty. *Political Analysis*.

Under Review

5. Let Time Tell: Identification and Gaussian Process Estimation for Interrupted Time Series. [**Job Market Paper**]
4. Non-existent Outcomes in Research on Inequality: A Causal Approach. (with Ian Lundberg) [**Minor revision**, *Sociological Methods & Research*]
3. Beyond Measurement-of-Mediation: Aligning Theory, Estimands, and Designs for More Credible Mediation-based Claims in Communication Research. (with Je Hoon Chae and Hyunjin (Jin) Song) [**Conditionally accepted**, *Human Communication Research*]
2. When Help Seems Optional: Institutional Projection Bias and Climate Refugee Disadvantage. (with Jieun Park and Margaret E. Peters)
1. Penalizing the Perpetual Foreigner: Partisanship, Gender, and Attitudes toward Asian Americans. (with Jieun Park and Jessica HyunJeong Lee)

Working Papers/Work in Progress

3. Covariate Imbalance and Non-Overlap in Interrupted Survey Designs: A Gaussian Process Approach. (with Chad Hazlett)
2. Estimating Time-Varying Treatment Effects under Misspecification. (with Ian Lundberg)
1. A GP Synthetic Control Method. (with Chad Hazlett and Wenlu Xu)

Statistical Software

gpss	R package on CRAN. Gaussian Processes for Social Science: extrapolation-aware estimation and inference for interrupted time series, regression discontinuity, and general regression settings, with hyperparameters selected automatically. With Doeun Kim and Chad Hazlett.
pstratreg	R package. Principal stratification for non-existent outcomes: estimates effects on outcome existence and effects among units whose outcomes exist under either treatment, using standard regression models. With Ian Lundberg.

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

2023–2025	**Conference Travel Grants**: UCLA Graduate Division (2023, 2024); CCPR (2025); Institute for Humane Studies (2025)
2024	**Travel Scholarship for ACIC**, Society for Causal Inference
2023–2024	**Initiative to Study Hate Research Grant** ($15,000), UCLA
2023–2024	**Dissertation Year Fellowship**, UCLA
2022, 2023	**Political Psychology Fellowship**, UCLA
2018–2023	**Kwanjeong Educational Foundation** Scholarship ($122,500) A competitive scholarship awarded for doctoral research abroad
2018–2020	**Graduate Dean's Scholar Award**, UCLA Graduate Division
2018–2020	**Irma Polaski Fellowship**, UCLA Graduate Division
2018–2023	**Funding for doctoral studies: Fellowship and TA position**, UCLA
2017	**Next-generation Researcher Fellowship**, Seoul National University
2016	**Best Research Paper**, Social Science Research Grant, Seoul National University

Teaching Experience

2025	**Instructor**, UCLA Data Analysis Workshop, PhD level (Fall 2025)
2019–2025	**Teaching Assistant/Fellow**, UCLA Causality, PhD level (Spring 2025, Statistics & Data Science) Quantitative Data Analysis, PhD level (Winter 2025, Sociology) Causal Inference for Social Science, PhD level (Spring 2022) **Lecture Notes** Politics & Strategy: Game Theory for Political Science (7 quarters, 2020–2023) Introduction to American Politics (3 quarters, 2019–2023) The American Presidency (Winter 2022)
2016–2018	**Teaching Assistant**, Seoul National University Quantitative Political Analysis (Grad); Research Methods in Political Science; Understanding and Analyzing Korean Politics; Studies in Chinese Politics

Research Experience

2024–2026	**Graduate Student Researcher**, UCLA Gaussian process methods for causal inference (with Chad Hazlett)
2023–2024	**Graduate Student Researcher**, Cornell University Principal stratification methods for non-existent outcomes (with Ian Lundberg)
2020–2021	**Graduate Research Assistant**, UCLA Construction and analysis of actual-ballot datasets, Los Angeles County, 1986–2010
2016–2018	**Graduate Research Assistant**, Seoul National University Projects on statistical software, legislative behavior, and governance experiments

Conference Presentations

2025	American Causal Inference Conference, Detroit, MI
2025	Population Association of America Annual Meeting, Washington, DC
2024	Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting, Riverside, CA
2024	American Causal Inference Conference, Seattle, WA
2023	American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA
2017	Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL

Professional Service

Reviewer for Political Science Research and Methods

Other Activities

2024 - Present	Affiliated with California Center for Population Research
2023 - Present	Affiliated with Practical Causal Inference Lab
2022 - 2025	**Graduate Student R Maven**, UCLA - Provide statistics/programming support for graduate students as a tutor
2021 - Present	Affiliated with Inequality Data Science Lab
2017	**Vice-President of Graduate Students Council**, Political Science Major, Seoul National University
2011-2013	**Staff Sergeant**, Republic of Korea Air Force (2 years)

Skills

R (advanced), Python (intermediate), C++, Stata, LaTeX, git/GitHub, Qualtrics